

Web watch

This time we take a look at "moonshot thinking" and other updates that have affected the web scene.



HTC One E8 saw a substantial drop in price

HTC's flagship M8, but that has reduced the price of the device to \$450 (approximately), which makes it about half the price of One M8 and other devices in its class, including the Galaxy S5.

After a substantial revenue drop in the month of May, HTC seems to have realised how to gain profit over the next coming months.

The HTC One E8 is expected to debut in India in July. The price of the smartphone has not been announced yet, but it is speculated that HTC may price the phone below ₹30,000 in India to compete with other mid-range smartphones.

HTC One X's struggle with Wi-Fi death grip issues

Since its launch, a few unfortunate owners of the HTC One X have complained of Wi-Fi and/or display issues, and while a software update has fixed most of the connectivity problems, some users still report a Wi-Fi death grip issue.

Similar to the iPhone 4's infamous voice and data death grip issue, the alleged issue affecting certain HTC One X devices is documented on XDA Developer's site, as the "HTC One X Wi-Fi antenna loose connection

fault", with model numbers HT23 and HT24 the most common identified problem-dealing handsets. We've also heard that the HTC One X units manufactured in Taiwan are the only ones facing the problem, not the handsets manufactured in China, though statistics have yet to back up that claim.

Unlike Apple and its stance on the iPhone 4's problems, however (where Jobs had told customers to hold the phone correctly), HTC has acknowledged the issue, and is reportedly keen on addressing it, based on user feedback.



Acknowledging the issue is half the problem solved

Affected users with the One X under warranty can freely claim a replacement. Right now, an XDA Developer member called 'Bigoliver' has reportedly posted a hardware fix to the problem, a relatively complicated method that includes tape and soldering.

The unit we received for our review of the HTC One X faced no such problem.

Aakash 2 – Made in China?

Controversies have continued to chase India's ambitious ultra low-cost tablet PC, the Aakash 2. According to reports on

App watch

Following the FIFA World Cup has never been easier. And these apps will make it so much better, it's almost criminal.

the web, the 'revolutionary' device aimed at bridging the digital divide in the country is actually a cheap 'Made in China' device, and has been embellished with some applications from IIT Bombay. Questions are being raised whether the Aakash 2 is a true Indian innovation.

Economic Times, in its report, claims that DataWind – the company assigned to design, develop and manufacture the Aakash tablet – procured about 12,000 A-13 model devices designed by AllWinner Tech of China. The supplier was finalised by IIT-Bombay, which is also implementing the Aakash project. The report says

that the procurement took place shortly before the Aakash 2 was officially launched.

The Chinese tablets cost about \$42 (around ₹2,310) per unit, and were purchased from firms such as Kalong Technology Co., Ltd, Dasen International Electronics Co Ltd, Trend Grace and Shenzhen Shetong Zhaoli Co Ltd. The report points out that IIT-Bombay issued a certificate dated 29th October for importing 20,000 units in India, and sought a waiver of duty as they were meant for school students under an HRD ministry programme – days before the Aakash 2 was launched.

Read more at: <http://dgit.in/aakashchina>



Datawind procured 12,000 devices designed by AllWinner Tech in China

Google to launch Apple CarPlay rival

Google announced the launch of its Google Auto Link (GAL) at the Google I/O developer conference in San Francisco in June. Google's Auto Link system is the first product developed in partnership with the Open Automotive Alliance – a group of companies including Audi, Honda, General Motors, Hyundai, chipmaker NVIDIA Corp and Google.



The Auto Play OS competes with Apple's CarPlay in-car operating system

Google's Auto Link software is not an "embedded" system but a "projected" one, meaning that smartphones using Google's Android operating system could be controlled using a car's own controls and display screen.

Google itself is quite familiar to many drivers from existing interfaces. Hyundai drivers already use an inbuilt Google search engine and voice commands to find nearby destinations and Audi drivers can use Google Earth satellite images for its GPS maps. Apart from Auto Link, Google is also planning to develop new Android platform features, which, the company says will, "enable the car itself to become a connected Android device".

The Auto Play OS competes with Apple's CarPlay in-car operating system unveiled at this year's Geneva Motor Show. Apple's Car Play interface resembles the iPhone and has several in-car functions. **d**